

10.2 Assessment information

This unit is assessed by means of a written examination paper of 1 hour 30 minutes' duration. Students may be required to apply their knowledge and understanding of biology from both the IAS and IA2 units in planning a complete investigation in some detail.

The total number of marks available for this examination paper is 50. It contributes 10 per cent to the International Advanced Level in Biology.

Students must have a calculator for this paper.

The examination will consist of three questions.

The first question will test students' knowledge and understanding of the experimental principles and applications of the practical work they have undertaken in Units 1, 2, 4 and 5.

The second question will test students' ability to tabulate and manipulate raw data and to recognise anomalous results and explain how they may be dealt with appropriately. They will be expected to suggest suitable statistical tests and interpret their results.

The third question will test students' ability to plan a safe scientific investigation, suggest ways in which the data collected might be analysed and evaluate the limitations of their planned methodology.

The examiners will use the *How Science Works* criteria and the criteria for the individual investigation when compiling this paper.